Yoorim Son

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Sogang University
M.A. Student in Economics
Seoul, Korea

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Education

Sogang University, Seoul, Korea — Mar 2025-present
M.A. in Economics; expected graduation: 2027
Advisor: Hyunjoo Yang

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies — Mar 2017-Feb 2021
B.A. in South African Languages and Cultures; Yongin, Korea
Minor in Political Science and Diplomacy

University of Botswana, Gaborone, Botswana — Jan-May 2018
Visiting / Exchange Student; coursework in Political Science

Research Interests

Development economics; applied microeconomics; digital infrastructure; local economic development and spatial inequality; geospatial and satellite-based economic measurement.

Working Papers

Mobile Broadband Upgrading and Spatial Inequality in South Africa
(with Hyunjoo Yang). October 2026.

Uses quarterly Ookla data to examine how mobile broadband upgrading during South Africa's 2021-2024 spectrum transition varies with initial quality, poverty, and regulatory priority.

Shows that reductions in low-speed disadvantage
can coexist with widening absolute speed gaps across municipalities.

Research Experience

Sogang Spatial Economics & AI Lab — Apr 2026-present
Research Group Member (Master's Student), Sogang University
Lab Head: Hyunjoo Yang

Work on crop-area prediction using machine learning and spatial data across Asian countries.

Built maize and rice ground-truth datasets, completed rice sampling, and am constructing XGBoost features for cultivated-area prediction.

MIRACLE: Subnational Economic Data for South Korea, 1960-1989 — Nov 2025-present
Research Associate
Project Leads: BooKang Seol, Changkeun Lee, and Hyunjoo Yang

Help build a consistent township-year economic panel from historical yearbooks and archival records.

Completed administrative-region data collection, coordinated a five-person team, and now work on OCR extraction and processing.

Seminars & Conferences

2026 Korean Economic Review (KER) International Conference — June 22, 2026
Halla Convention Center, Jeju, South Korea

The Economic Impact of Submarine Cable Arrival on Local Economic Activity: Evidence from South Africa (with Hyunjoo Yang).
Presenter; Contributed Session A5: Empirical Microeconomics

Examines how international connectivity gains translate into local broadband upgrading and economic activity in South Africa.

Planned Collaboration

Satellite-Based Measurement of North Korean Economic Activity — Upcoming
Bank of Korea

Planned collaboration using satellite observations to measure North Korean industrial production where conventional economic statistics are limited.

Methods & Data

Programming: Python.
Empirical methods: Fixed effects, event studies, spatial exposure designs, synthetic-control diagnostics; training in difference-in-differences and instrumental variables.
Machine learning: XGBoost, sampling, and feature construction.
Data: Panel and administrative data, broadband performance, GIS and satellite-derived measures, historical archives, crop ground-truth data, and OCR workflows.

Languages

Korean: Native; English: Intermediate (academic reading and writing).